

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Sovereign Infrastructure Investment Memorandum

The Bristol Gateway Port Renaissance Programme

**A Public–Private Partnership to Transform Bristol Port into
Britain's Western Trade, Energy and Industrial Gateway**

Executive Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management (EVWM) proposes the creation of the:

Bristol Gateway Port Investment Partnership (BGPIP)

A long-term sovereign-style infrastructure investment vehicle to expand and modernise the **Port of Bristol / Avonmouth–Royal Portbury complex** into one of Britain's leading:

- container ports
- renewable energy hubs
- industrial logistics centres
- offshore wind bases
- green fuel facilities
- Western European trade gateways

The investment thesis:

Bristol should not merely serve the South West economy. It should become the Atlantic gateway for the entire Western UK economy.

The Port of Bristol already occupies a strategically important position. Avonmouth and the wider Severnside area contain around 640 hectares of port, industrial and logistics activity, supporting approximately 10,000 port-related jobs.

The port also has existing ambitions for major expansion, including a deep-sea container terminal and offshore wind infrastructure.

EVWM proposes accelerating this transformation through a £5 billion public-private partnership.

1. Strategic Vision

Bristol as Britain's Atlantic Gateway

Britain's major ports are concentrated around:

- Felixstowe
- Southampton
- London Gateway
- Liverpool

The western side of Britain lacks an equivalent large-scale gateway.

Bristol has unique advantages:

Geography

Direct access to:

- South Wales
- South West England
- Midlands
- Ireland
- Atlantic trade routes

Existing Infrastructure

Connected to:

- M5 motorway
- M49
- national rail freight network

The Avonmouth Severnside area is already identified as a nationally important industrial and logistics location due to its connections and scale.

2. Investment Objective

Create:

Bristol Atlantic Port City

A port ecosystem combining:

Trade

Containers, imports, exports

Energy

Offshore wind, hydrogen, LNG, renewable fuels

Manufacturing

Advanced industry

Logistics

Warehousing and distribution

Innovation

Maritime technology

3. Investment Structure

Bristol Gateway Port Fund

Total Programme:

£5 billion

30-year investment horizon

Capital structure:

Investor	Contribution
EVWM	£1bn
UK pension funds	£2bn
Private infrastructure investors	£1bn
Government partnership	£1bn

Pillar One

Deep Sea Container Expansion

Investment:

£1.5 billion

Objective

Create a major western container gateway capable of handling larger modern vessels.

The Bristol Port Company already has consent for a deep-sea container terminal on a brownfield site at Avonmouth.

Development

Create:

- new container berths
 - automated cranes
 - rail freight terminals
 - customs facilities
 - logistics parks
-

Target Capacity

Additional:

1–2 million TEU annually

Economic Benefit

Reduces dependence on southern ports.

Benefits:

- fewer truck miles
 - lower logistics costs
 - improved supply resilience
-

Pillar Two

Bristol Offshore Wind Energy Hub

Investment:

£1 billion

The Celtic Sea offshore wind opportunity creates a major industrial opportunity for South West England.

A proposed Bristol Wind Terminal at Avonmouth is intended to support floating offshore wind development, with regulatory processes underway.

Create:

Bristol Renewable Energy Port

Facilities:

- turbine assembly
 - blade storage
 - offshore maintenance
 - marine engineering
-

Target industries:

- floating offshore wind
 - tidal energy
 - hydrogen
 - subsea engineering
-

Economic impact:

10,000+ specialised jobs over decades

Pillar Three

Green Industrial Port

Investment:

£750 million

Transform Avonmouth into a low-carbon industrial cluster.

Assets:

Hydrogen Production

Using:

- offshore wind electricity
 - imported renewable fuels
-

Carbon Management

Support:

- industrial decarbonisation
 - carbon capture logistics
-

Circular Economy

Facilities:

- recycling
 - materials recovery
 - advanced processing
-

Bristol's economic strategy already identifies Avonmouth as a future green industrial cluster involving hydrogen, alternative fuels and industrial decarbonisation.

Pillar Four

Port Rail Renaissance

Investment:

£750 million

The objective:

Move freight from road to rail.

Projects:

Avonmouth Freight Rail Terminal

Increase:

- container trains
 - intermodal freight
 - industrial rail access
-

Bristol–Midlands Freight Corridor

Connect:

Bristol Port

↓

Birmingham

↓

East Midlands

↓

Northern England

Benefits:

- reduced congestion
 - lower emissions
 - improved logistics efficiency
-

Pillar Five

Port City Innovation District

Investment:

£500 million

Create:

Bristol Maritime Technology Quarter

Businesses:

- robotics
 - autonomous shipping
 - marine engineering
 - logistics software
 - AI supply chains
-

Partners:

- University of Bristol
 - University of the West of England
 - maritime companies
-

Pillar Six

Avonmouth Port City Development

Investment:

£500 million

Redevelop underused industrial land.

Create:

- worker housing
- offices

- training centres
 - hotels
 - services
-

Concept:

A modern port city similar to:

- Rotterdam
 - Hamburg
 - Singapore
-

Economic Model

Investment

£5 billion

Direct Economic Effects

Construction:

Estimated:

50,000+ job-years

Permanent employment:

Sector	Jobs
Port operations	5,000
Logistics	10,000
Energy	8,000
Manufacturing	10,000
Services	5,000

Potential:

35,000+ additional jobs

GDP Impact

Regional Economy

The West of England is already a high-value economy with strong aerospace, engineering and technology sectors.

The port expansion creates:

- trade growth
 - productivity improvements
 - investment attraction
 - industrial clustering
-

Conservative Estimate

Annual GVA uplift:

£1.5–2 billion

Growth Scenario

With energy and manufacturing clusters:

£3 billion+ annual GVA uplift

Revenue Streams

The investment fund earns through:

Port Operations

- handling fees
 - terminal charges
-

Logistics

- warehousing
 - industrial estates
-

Energy

- offshore wind services
 - hydrogen infrastructure
-

Property

- commercial development
-

Expected Investment Returns

Infrastructure assets:

6–8%

Industrial property:

8–10%

Energy assets:

8–12%

Strategic Relationship With Wider EVWM Portfolio

The Bristol Port Renaissance connects with:

Energy

- tidal power
- LNG flexibility
- offshore wind

Transport

- Midland rail upgrades
- South West connectivity

Urban Growth

- Bristol regeneration

Tourism

- Atlantic gateway economy
-

Final Recommendation

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management recommends establishing:

The Bristol Gateway Port Investment Partnership

A sovereign-style infrastructure fund to transform Bristol into:

Britain's Atlantic Industrial Gateway

The strategic opportunity is not simply expanding a port.

It is creating an integrated economic system:

Port + Energy + Manufacturing + Logistics + Technology

The next century of British economic growth will depend on strategic gateways.

Bristol has the geography, industrial base and maritime history to become one of them.